

SVC-07 - VPN / Remote Access Request

Description

Summit IT uses **Palo Alto GlobalProtect** as its enterprise VPN. VPN access is required to reach internal applications, on-premises file shares, and network resources that are not exposed through the public internet. Cloud-based SaaS applications (Microsoft 365, Slack, Zoom, Salesforce) do not require VPN.

GlobalProtect is pre-installed on all Summit IT-managed laptops and is activated using Okta credentials and Okta Verify MFA. Most employees receive VPN access automatically as part of their standard onboarding.

This service covers:

- Requesting VPN access for employees who did not receive it at onboarding
- Enabling VPN for contractors and temporary workers
- Requesting an **Always-On VPN** profile (for roles requiring continuous internal access)
- Requesting **split-tunnel exceptions** for specific traffic (Engineering only)
- Troubleshooting VPN connectivity issues

Who Can Request

All full-time and part-time employees. Contractor VPN requests require manager **and** IT Security approval and are time-limited to the contract end date.

What's Included

VPN Profile	Description	Eligible Roles
Standard (default)	On-demand VPN; user connects manually when needed; split-tunnel to Summit internal resources	All employees
Always-On	GlobalProtect connects automatically on network change; all traffic routed through Summit gateway	IT, Security, Finance, Legal
Contractor / Temp	Standard profile; expires on contract end date; access limited to approved internal resources only	Contractors

Split-tunnel exception	Specific third-party traffic excluded from VPN tunnel (e.g., lab environments)	Engineering (L2/L3 approval)
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Internal Resources Accessible via VPN

- On-premises file shares: \\summit-fs01\ and \\summit-fs02\
- Internal web applications on *.internal.summitit.com
- DevOps toolchain (Jenkins, Artifactory, internal GitLab)
- Network printers at HQ and regional offices
- IT management consoles (Intune admin, Jamf admin) - restricted profiles only

How to Request

If GlobalProtect is already installed but VPN access is not working: 1. Verify you can authenticate at <https://help.summitit.com> (Okta must be working). 2. Open a Support ticket at <https://help.summitit.com> -> **Get Help -> VPN / Remote Access Issue**.

If you need VPN access provisioned or a profile change: 1. Go to <https://help.summitit.com> -> **Request a Service -> Network & Access -> VPN / Remote Access**. 2. Select the access type: Standard, Always-On, Contractor, or Split-Tunnel Exception. 3. For contractor requests, enter the contract end date. 4. For split-tunnel exception requests, list the specific IP ranges or domains to be excluded and the engineering justification. 5. Submit. Contractor and split-tunnel requests route to IT Security for approval.

Fulfillment SLA

Request Type	Target Fulfillment	Notes
Standard VPN access	1 business day	P4 SLA
Always-On VPN profile	2 business days	P4 SLA; requires Security review
Contractor VPN access	3 business days	P4 SLA; Security approval required
Split-tunnel exception	5 business days	P3 SLA; requires L3 Engineering + Security sign-off
VPN connectivity incident	4 business hours	P3 SLA for single user; P1 if affecting multiple users

Cost / Chargeback

VPN access is provided at no additional cost to departments. GlobalProtect licenses are part of the Summit IT infrastructure budget.

Security Requirements

- VPN connections require **Okta Verify MFA** on every new connection.
- Devices must have **CrowdStrike Falcon** active and reporting healthy to the gateway. Unhealthy endpoints are blocked until remediated.
- VPN sessions automatically disconnect after **8 hours** of inactivity.
- Personal (unmanaged) devices are not permitted to connect to the corporate VPN.

Related Services

- [SVC-03 - Application / Data Access Request](#)
- [SVC-04 - New Hire IT Setup](#)
- [Contractor & Temp Access Setup](#)